

Accelerating with Copilot

Microsoft 365 Copilot | Faster first drafts, not final products

Day 2 • 09:15 – 11:30

WHERE COPILOT SITS IN THE DATA LIFECYCLE



FIVE KEY PRINCIPLES FROM THIS MODULE

- Prompt with specificity — vague prompts produce vague outputs. Use the five-component structure every time.
- Copilot is a first draft, not a final product — every output requires human review before use or sharing.
- Validate against reality — for outputs with numbers, names, or facts, verify against the source.
- Build workflows, not one-off prompts — reusable prompt templates for recurring tasks save the most time.
- Know your limits — some tasks are faster and safer done manually. Recognise which ones.

THE FIVE-COMPONENT PROMPT STRUCTURE

1. Role	Tell Copilot who it is acting as. E.g. 'Act as a data analyst reviewing an NHS compliance report...'
2. Context	Describe the data, document, or situation. E.g. 'This is a monthly mandatory training tracker for Barts Health staff...'
3. Task	State clearly what you want Copilot to do. E.g. 'Summarise the key patterns in completion rates by directorate...'
4. Constraints	Set limits on length, format, or scope. E.g. '...in no more than three bullet points, avoiding jargon.'
5. Output format	Specify how results should be presented. E.g. 'as a table' or 'as a slide title with three supporting bullets.'

Example prompt using all five components

Act as a data analyst [Role]. I have a spreadsheet showing mandatory training completion rates by directorate at Barts Health for October 2024 [Context]. Summarise the three most significant findings [Task] in plain English, avoiding clinical jargon [Constraints], formatted as three bullet points each starting with the directorate name [Output format].

COPILOT ACROSS THE M365 SUITE — WHAT TO USE IT FOR

Tool	Best uses	Always check...
Excel	Generate formulas, explain what a dataset contains, summarise a column in plain language	That the formula does what it claims — test against 2-3 known values manually
PowerPoint	Generate first-draft slide structure from a prompt or Word document; rewrite slide titles as insight-led headlines	That specific data cited is accurate; that formatting meets Barts Health standards

Word	Draft narrative summaries from data tables; rewrite for tone or audience; summarise long documents	That the summary captures all significant findings and hasn't omitted anything material
Outlook	Draft emails to stakeholders from a brief description; summarise long email threads	Tone is appropriate for the specific recipient; any data referenced is correct
Teams	Generate meeting summaries with decisions and actions; surface questions from transcripts	All actions have correct owners; no decisions have been omitted or misrepresented

VALIDATION CHECKLIST — BEFORE YOU USE OR SHARE ANY COPILOT OUTPUT

Accuracy	Are all numbers, names, dates, and facts correct? Has Copilot invented anything plausible-sounding?
Completeness	Has Copilot captured everything that matters, or has it omitted a significant finding in the summary?
Tone & register	Is the language appropriate for the intended audience — clinical lead, manager, board, team?
Barts Health fit	Does the output reflect Barts Health context and terminology, or is it generic?
Actionability	If the output includes a recommendation or ask — is it clear, specific, and addressed to the right person?

High-value vs high-risk Copilot tasks

HIGH VALUE: drafting, summarising, reformatting, rewriting for a different audience, generating formula syntax. **HIGH RISK** without strong validation: any output containing specific numbers, named individuals, clinical references, or policy statements. **LOW VALUE:** tasks where writing a good prompt and reviewing the output takes longer than doing it manually.

